MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DEVOPS / PLATFORM ENGINEERING | QA AUTOMATION & TEST INFRASTRUCTURE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation and test-infrastructure engineer with 7 years of experience, including ownership of CI/CD pipelines and Kubernetes-based test environments for three product teams. Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and helped lower flaky test rates from 7% to under 1%. Builds and maintains automation with GitLab CI, Docker, Helm, Python and Bash. Developing infrastructure-as-code and cloud skills through a personal k3s and Terraform project and AWS learning. Currently studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam, scheduled for January 2027.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and build tooling: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose
Containers and orchestration: Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access and test environments), k3s (personal homelab)
Infrastructure as code and automation: Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS project), Ansible (basic), Bash, Python
Cloud learning: AWS (EC2 and S3 basics)
Monitoring and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Other: Linux, Git, Java (test code)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021-present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; flaky test rate fell from 7% to under 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data and built Grafana dashboards for flaky-test metrics using CI results stored in PostgreSQL.
- Wrote an internal guide to CI workflows used in onboarding and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019-2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated approaches.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project and configured Jenkins nightly regression jobs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House | 2018-2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECT

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal project | 2024-2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam scheduled for January 2027; currently studying

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)